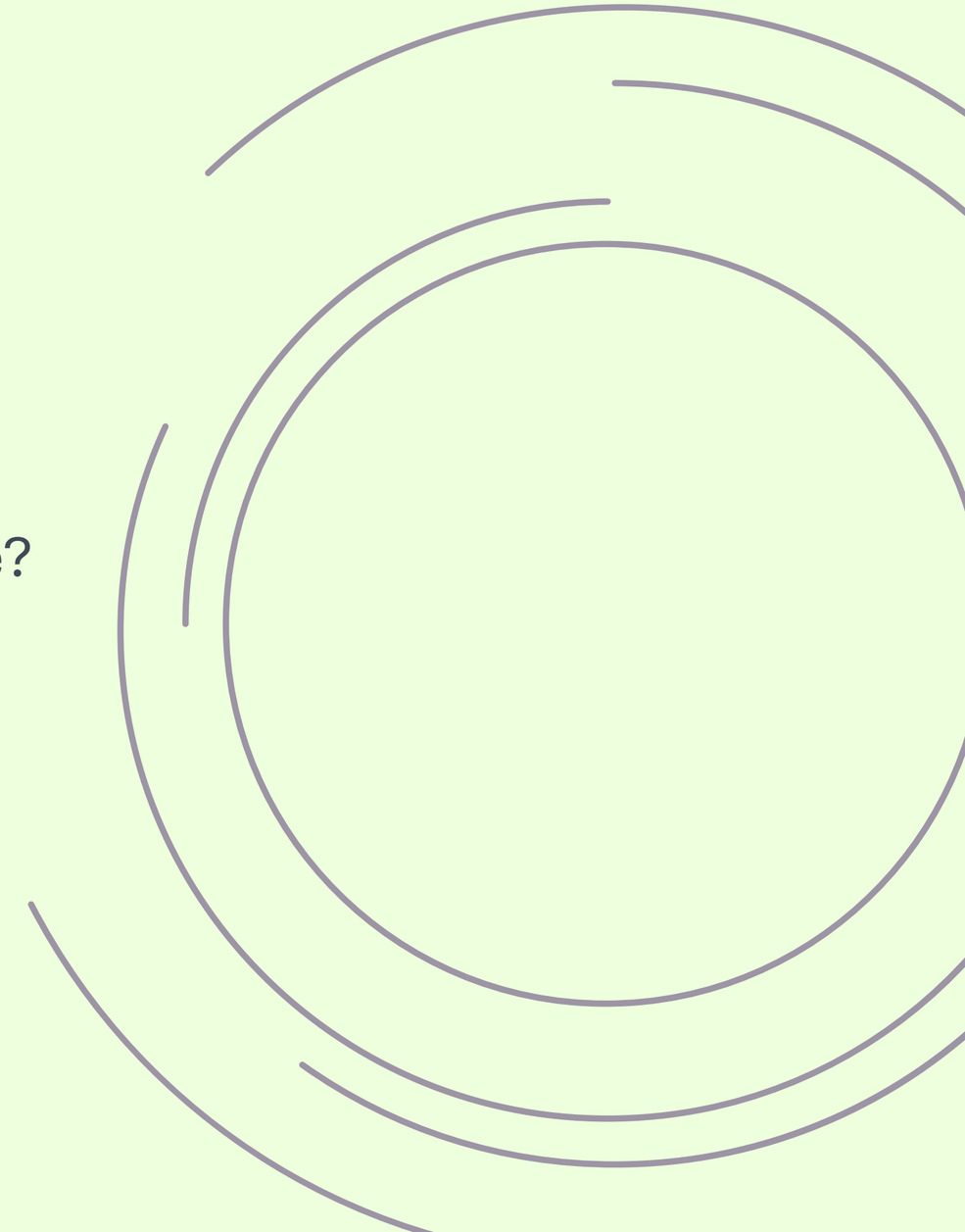
CROSS-ADDICTION

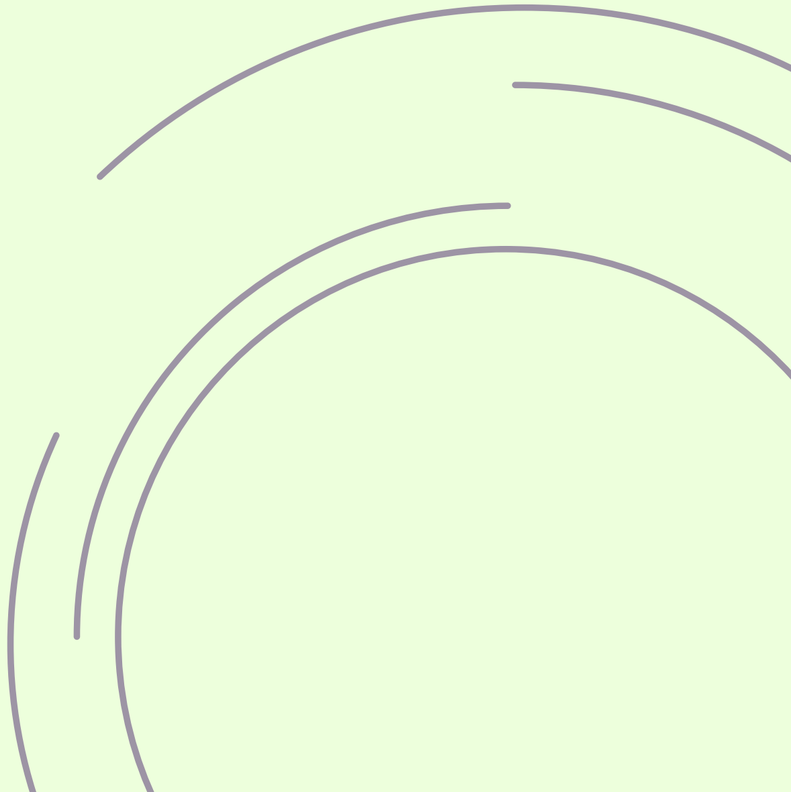
When the substance changes, does the pattern change?



What do you think?

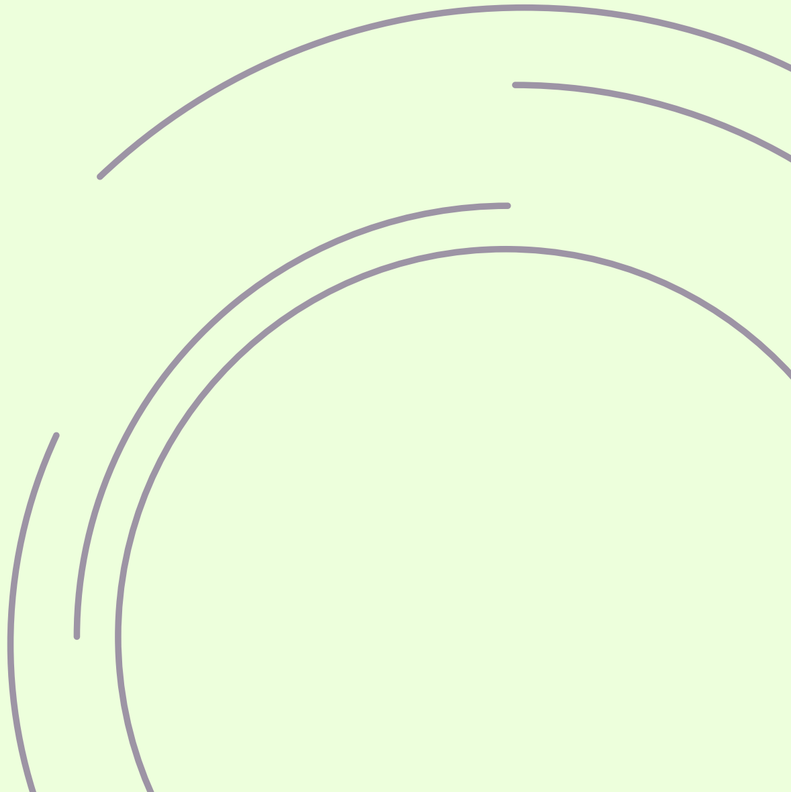
In your own words, what does cross-addiction mean?

A shift from one problematic substance or behavior to another.



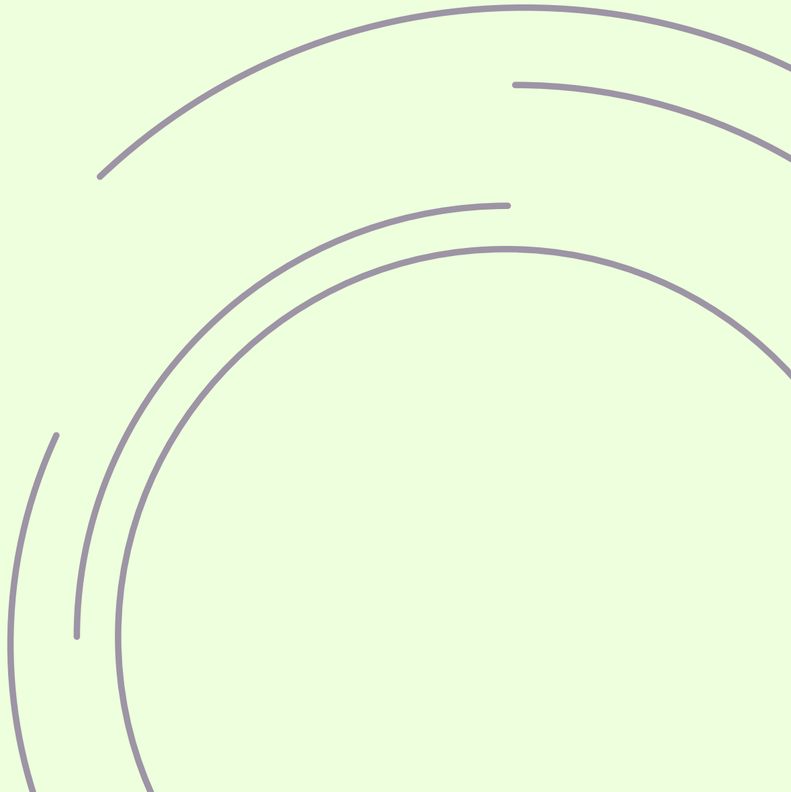
A shift from one problematic substance or behavior to another.

Useful recovery concept ≠ formal diagnosis



What can change?

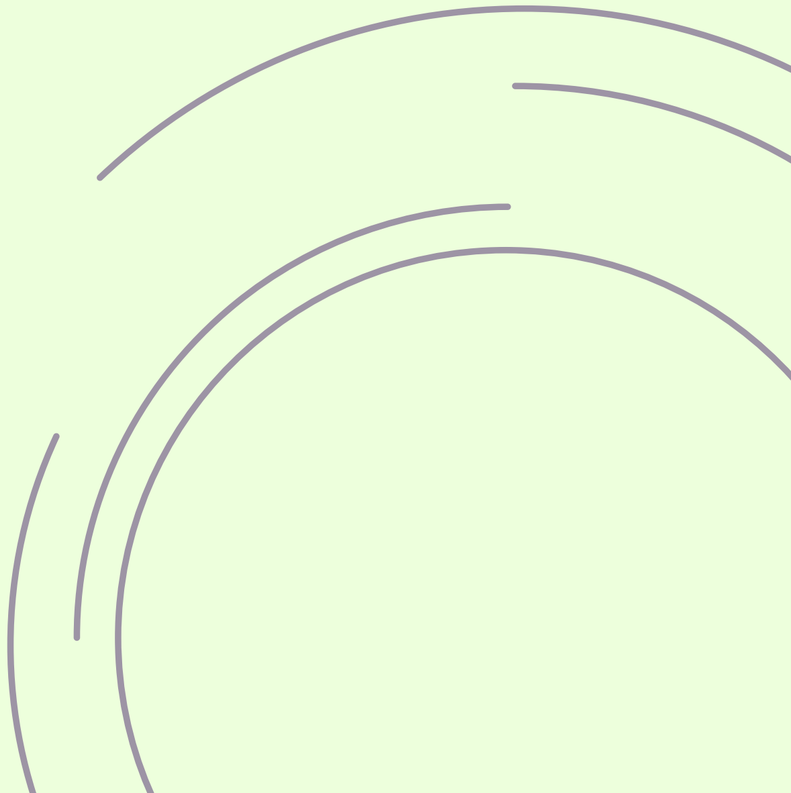
Substance → Substance



What can change?

Substance → Substance

Substance → Behavior

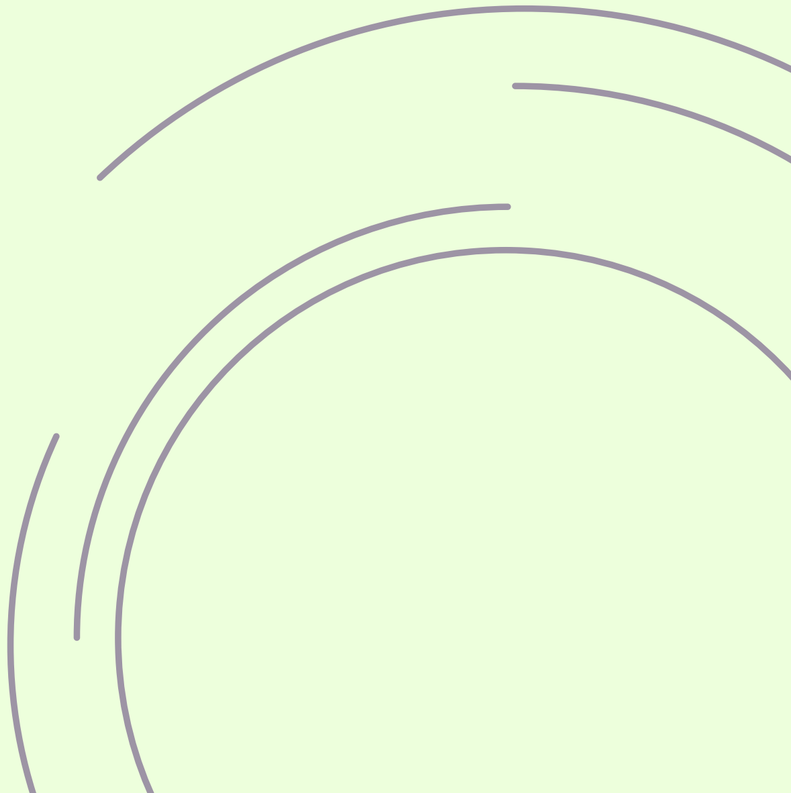


What can change?

Substance → Substance

Substance → Behavior

Behavior → Behavior



What can change?

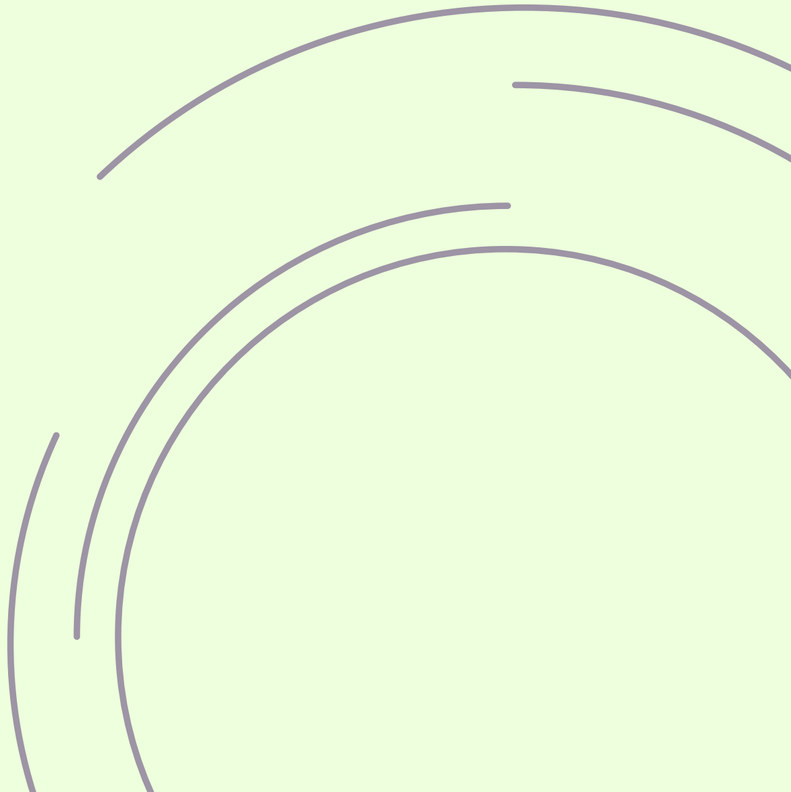
Substance → Substance

Substance → Behavior

Behavior → Behavior

What might stay the same?

What did your substance do for you?



What did your substance do for you?

Escape	Energy	Confidence
Relief	Numbing	Connection
Sleep	Reward	Excitement

Something else?

The substance was a solution.

The substance was a solution.

Until the solution became another problem.

The substance was a solution.

Until the solution became another problem.

The solution becomes the problem when it stops being a choice.

How does a solution become a pattern?

How does a solution become a pattern?

Something works.

How does a solution become a pattern?

Something works.

So I remember it.

How does a solution become a pattern?

Something works.

So I remember it.

I use it again when I want the same result.

How does a solution become a pattern?

Something works.

So I remember it.

I use it again when I want the same result.

It works again.

How does a solution become a pattern?

Something works.

So I remember it.

I use it again when I want the same result.

It works again.

So it becomes easier to reach for next time.

How does a solution become a pattern?

Something works.

So I remember it.

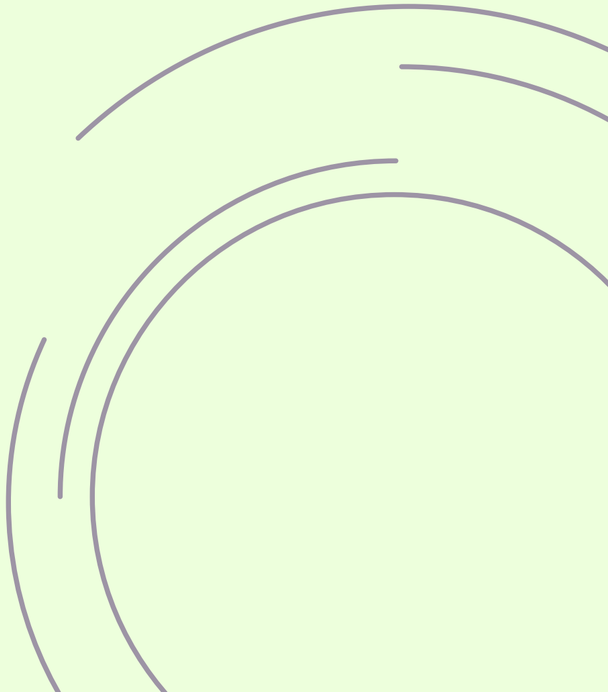
I use it again when I want the same result.

It works again.

So it becomes easier to reach for next time.

At what point am I reaching automatically instead of choosing intentionally?

“But it’s not my DOC.”



What actually changes the risk?

History

Function

Consequences

Recovery Stability

Frequency/Amount

Control

Medical Context

Honesty/Secrecy

What actually changes the risk?

History

Function

Frequency/amount

Control

Consequences

Recovery stability

Medical context

Honesty/secrecy

“Not my DOC” is one piece of information – not the whole assessment.

“What’s the deal with ‘gateway’ drugs?”

“What’s the deal with ‘gateway’ drugs?”

“Soft” → “Hard”

“What’s the deal with ‘gateway’ drugs?”

“Soft” → “Hard”

Does first mean caused?

What else could explain the order?

Access

Exposure

Environment

Vulnerability

“Soft” vs. “Hard”

“Soft” vs. “Hard”

What are we acutally describing?

“Soft” vs. “Hard”

What are we acutally describing?

Access? **Legality?** **Acceptance?** **Risk?**

“Aren’t you just replacing one drug with another?

Same Thing?

Same Thing?

WHAT is it?

Same Thing?

WHAT is it?

WHY am I using it?

Same Thing?

WHAT is it?

WHY am I using it?

HOW am I using it?

Same Thing?

WHAT is it?

WHY am I using it?

HOW am I using it?

WHAT is happening because of it?

Same Thing?

WHAT is it?

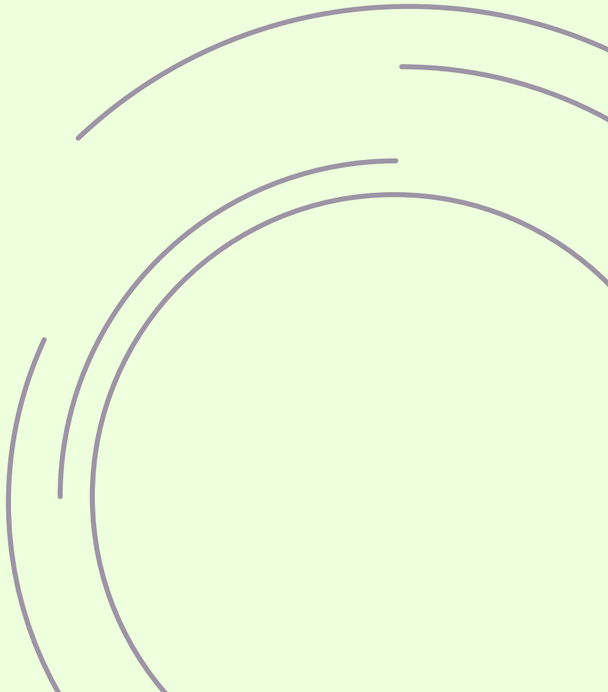
WHY am I using it?

HOW am I using it?

WHAT is happening because of it?

The label doesn’t tell us the whole pattern.

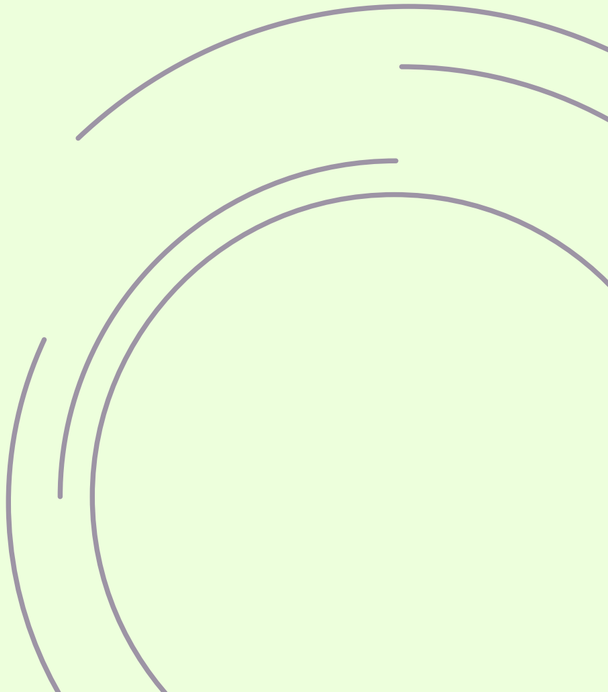
Can you get “addicted” to anything?



Can you get “addicted” to anything?

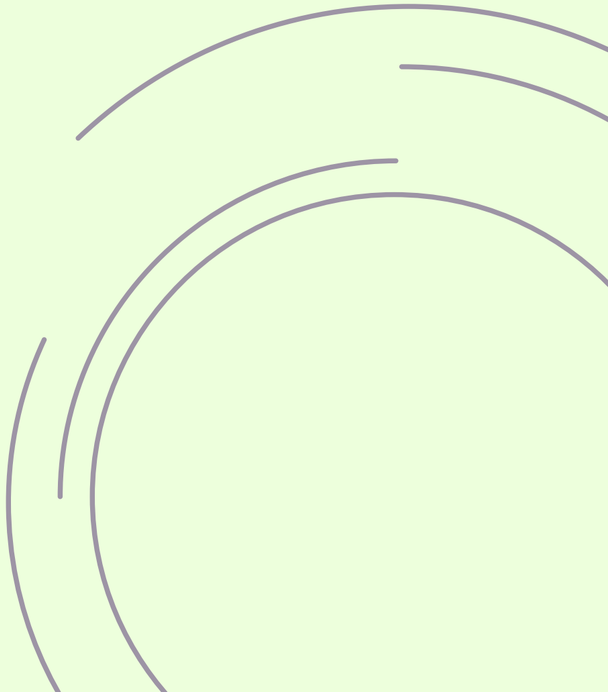
What do we mean when we say “addicted”?

“I do it a lot.”



“I do it a lot.”

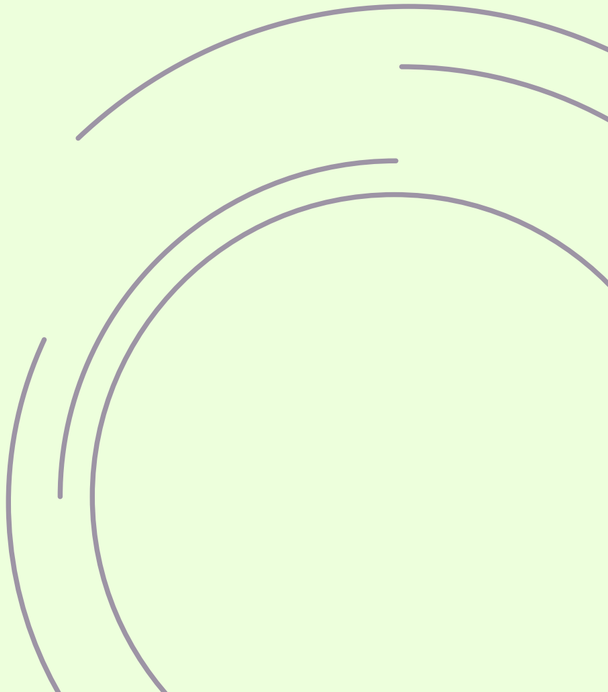
Does that make it a problem?



“I do it a lot.”

Does that make it a problem?

Can I control it?



“I do it a lot.”

Does that make it a problem?

Can I control it?

What is it doing for me?

“I do it a lot.”

Does that make it a problem?

Can I control it?

What is it doing for me?

What happens when I can’t do it?

“I do it a lot.”

Does that make it a problem?

Can I control it?

What is it doing for me?

What happens when I can’t do it?

Is something important getting pushed aside?

“I do it a lot.”

Does that make it a problem?

Can I control it?

What is it doing for me?

What happens when I can’t do it?

Is something important getting pushed aside?

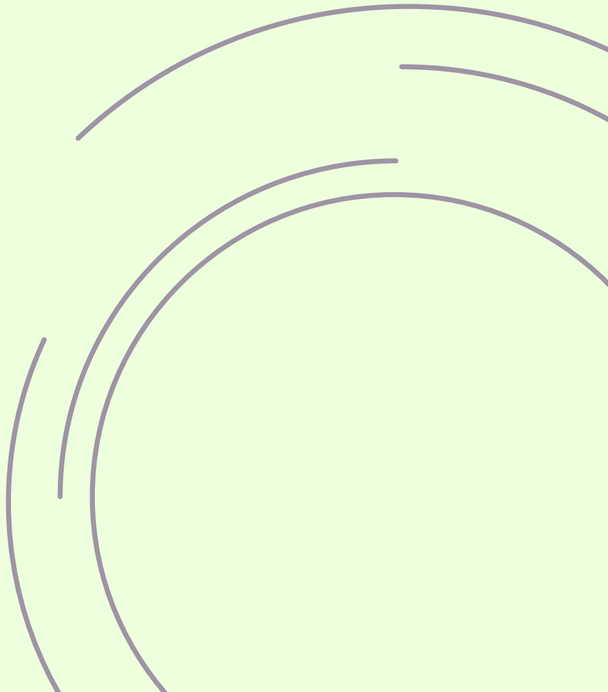
Am I continuing despite consequences?

“I do it a lot.”

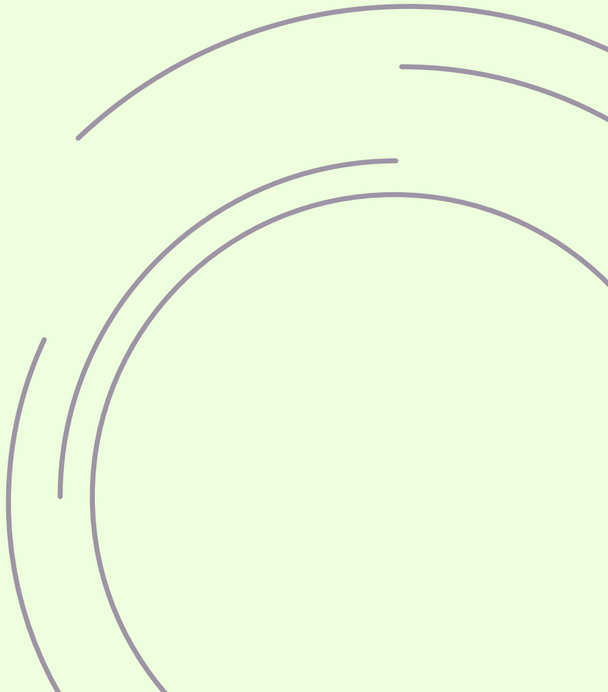
Does that make it a problem?

Frequency is information.

It isn’t the whole answer.

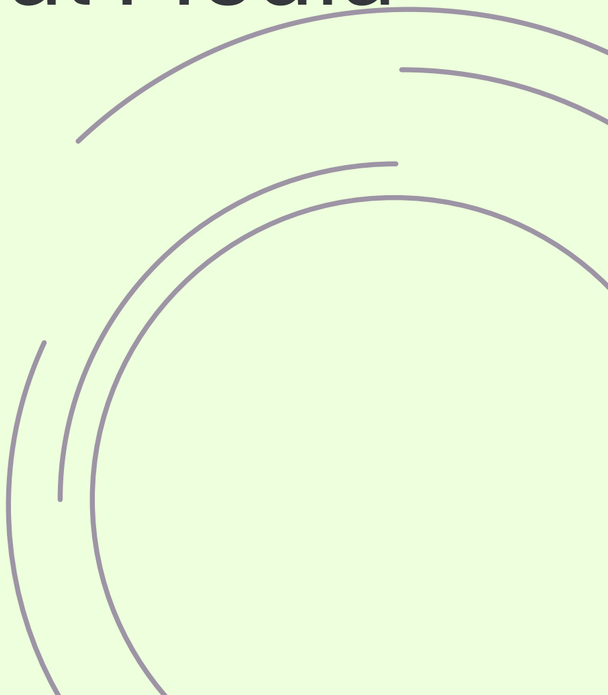


Same label?



Same label?

Gambling	Gaming	Shopping	Sex
Exercise	Eating	Work	Social Media



Same label?

Gambling Gaming Shopping Sex

Exercise Eating Work Social Media

Are all of these clinically “addictions?”

Same label?

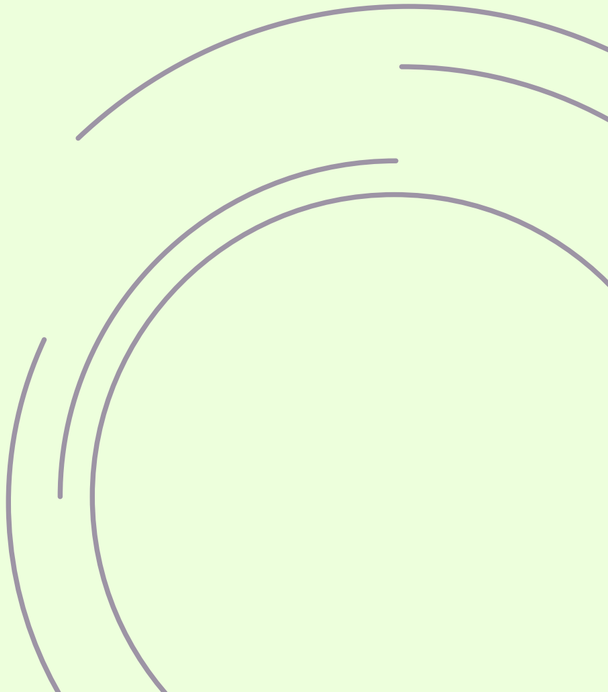
Gambling Gaming Shopping Sex

Exercise Eating Work Social Media

Are all of these clinically “addictions?”

Not necessarily.

Does the label have to come first?



Does the label have to come first?

If something is hurting your recovery, do you need an official diagnosis before you address it?

Does the label have to come first?

If something is hurting your recovery, do you need an official diagnosis before you address it?

A problem is allowed to be a problem before it becomes a diagnosis.

The Four Fs

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

The Four Fs

Function

What is it doing for me?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

The Four Fs

Function

What is it doing for me?

Freedom

How much choice do I still have?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

The Four Fs

Function

What is it doing for me?

Freedom

How much choice do I still have?

Focus

How much of my life is organizing around it?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

The Four Fs

Function

What is it doing for me?

Freedom

How much choice do I still have?

Focus

How much of my life is organizing around it?

Fallout

What is it costing me?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Function

What is it doing for me?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Function

What is it doing for me?

Relief Escape Energy

Connection Reward Control

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Function

What is it doing for me?

Relief Escape Energy

Connection Reward Control

What need am I trying to meet?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Freedom

How much choice do I still have?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Freedom

How much choice do I still have?

Can I wait? Can I change the plan?

Can I stop when I intended to?

Do I keep making rules – and then breaking them?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Freedom

How much choice do I still have?

Can I wait? Can I change the plan?

Can I stop when I intended to?

Do I keep making rules – and then breaking them?

Am I choosing it – or does it feel like it is choosing for me?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Focus

How much space is it taking up?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Focus

How much space is it taking up?

Thoughts Time Planning Money Priorities

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Focus

How much space is it taking up?

Thoughts Time Planning Money Priorities

What is getting pushed aside?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Fallout

What is it costing me?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Fallout

What is it costing me?

Work Money Health Relationships

Values Recovery Responsibilities

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Fallout

What is it costing me?

Work Money Health Relationships

Values Recovery Responsibilities

Am I continuing even though I can see the cost?

Reflection tool – not a diagnostic test.

Meet Tim

Meet Tim

Tim has been sober for a little over 30 days.

Meet Tim

Tim has been sober for a little over 30 days.

He’s doing well in IOP and attending meetings.

Meet Tim

Tim has been sober for a little over 30 days.

He’s doing well in IOP and attending meetings.

He starts a relationship with someone from his group.

Meet Tim

Tim has been sober for a little over 30 days.

He’s doing well in IOP and attending meetings.

He starts a relationship with someone from his group.

Meetings start becoming hookups.

Meet Tim

Tim has been sober for a little over 30 days.

He’s doing well in IOP and attending meetings.

He starts a relationship with someone from his group.

Meetings start becoming hookups.

He begins keeping the relationship secret.

Meet Tim

Tim has been sober for a little over 30 days.

He’s doing well in IOP and attending meetings.

He starts a relationship with someone from his group.

Meetings start becoming hookups.

He begins keeping the relationship secret.

He thinks, “At least I’m still clean.”

Meet Tim

Tim has been sober for a little over 30 days.
He’s doing well in IOP and attending meetings.
He starts a relationship with someone from his group.
Meetings start becoming hookups.
He begins keeping the relationship secret.
He thinks, “At least I’m still clean.”
Then he starts missing IOP.

Tim

What do you notice?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Tim

What do you notice?

What else would you need to know?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Meet Lana

Meet Lana

Sober for 90 days and is finishing treatment.

Meet Lana

Sober for 90 days and is finishing treatment.

She has a good job and more disposable income now that she isn’t using.

Meet Lana

Sober for 90 days and is finishing treatment.

She has a good job and more disposable income now that she isn’t using.

Shopping becomes an emotional escape.

Meet Lana

Sober for 90 days and is finishing treatment.
She has a good job and more disposable income now that she isn’t using.
Shopping becomes an emotional escape.
Her credit-card balances start climbing.

Meet Lana

Sober for 90 days and is finishing treatment.
She has a good job and more disposable income now that she isn’t using.
Shopping becomes an emotional escape.
Her credit-card balances start climbing.
Her paycheck disappears almost as quickly as when she was in active addiction.

Lana

What do you notice?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Lana

What do you notice?

What else would you need to know?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Meet Buck

Meet Buck

Buck has been sober for more than two years.

Meet Buck

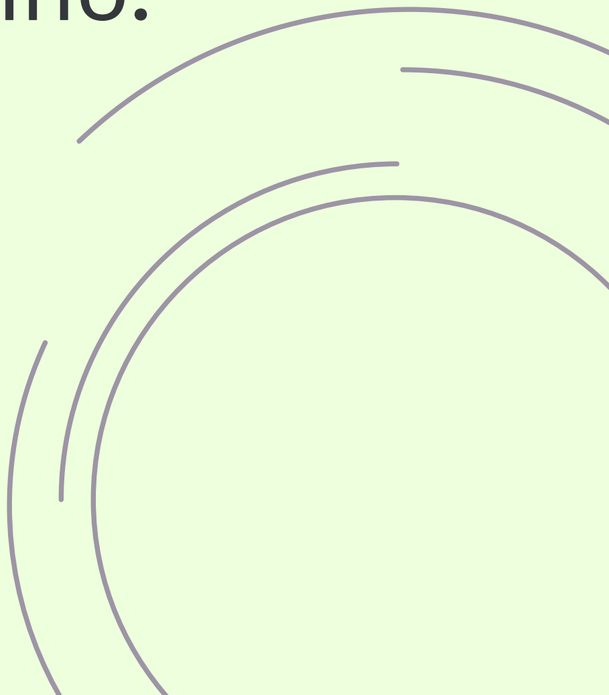
Buck has been sober for more than two years.
He completed treatment and remains active in recovery.

Meet Buck

Buck has been sober for more than two years.
He completed treatment and remains active in recovery.
He sponsors other people.

Meet Buck

Buck has been sober for more than two years.
He completed treatment and remains active in recovery.
He sponsors other people.
He starts spending his weekends at the casino.



Meet Buck

Buck has been sober for more than two years.
He completed treatment and remains active in recovery.
He sponsors other people.
He starts spending his weekends at the casino.
He becomes unavailable when his sponsees need him.

Meet Buck

Buck has been sober for more than two years.
He completed treatment and remains active in recovery.
He sponsors other people.
He starts spending his weekends at the casino.
He becomes unavailable when his sponsees need him.
He secretly spends half of his savings.

Meet Buck

Buck has been sober for more than two years.
He completed treatment and remains active in recovery.
He sponsors other people.
He starts spending his weekends at the casino.
He becomes unavailable when his sponsees need him.
He secretly spends half of his savings.
He thinks, “One more good weekend and I’ll win it all back.”

Buck

What do you notice?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Buck

What do you notice?

What else would you need to know?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Meet Leslie

Meet Leslie

Leslie is new to recovery and has been feeling lonely.

Meet Leslie

Leslie is new to recovery and has been feeling lonely. She starts spending more time on social media and connecting with with people online.

Meet Leslie

Leslie is new to recovery and has been feeling lonely. She starts spending more time on social media and connecting with with people online.
Her time online gradually increases.

Meet Leslie

Leslie is new to recovery and has been feeling lonely.
She starts spending more time on social media and connecting with with people online.
Her time online gradually increases.
She becomes less available to family.

Meet Leslie

Leslie is new to recovery and has been feeling lonely.
She starts spending more time on social media and connecting with with people online.
Her time online gradually increases.
She becomes less available to family.
It begins interfering with her work.

Meet Leslie

Leslie is new to recovery and has been feeling lonely.
She starts spending more time on social media and connecting with with people online.
Her time online gradually increases.
She becomes less available to family.
It begins interfering with her work.
When she can’t check her phone, she finds herself thinking about when she can get back online.

Leslie

What do you notice?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Leslie

What do you notice?

What else would you need to know?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Meet Jack

Meet Jack

Sober for five years after struggling with alcohol.

Meet Jack

Sober for five years after struggling with alcohol.
Injured in an accident and develops significant back pain.

Meet Jack

Sober for five years after struggling with alcohol.
Injured in an accident and develops significant back pain.
His doctor provides pain medication.

Meet Jack

Sober for five years after struggling with alcohol.

Injured in an accident and develops significant back pain.

His doctor provides pain medication.

He takes it as prescribed without any problems for the first three months.

Meet Jack

Sober for five years after struggling with alcohol.

Injured in an accident and develops significant back pain.

His doctor provides pain medication.

He takes it as prescribed without any problems for the first three months.

Then he starts running out early.

Meet Jack

Sober for five years after struggling with alcohol.

Injured in an accident and develops significant back pain.

His doctor provides pain medication.

He takes it as prescribed without any problems for the first three months.

Then he starts running out early.

He starts getting additional opioids and benzodiazepines outside his prescription.

Meet Jack

Sober for five years after struggling with alcohol.

Injured in an accident and develops significant back pain.

His doctor provides pain medication.

He takes it as prescribed without any problems for the first three months.

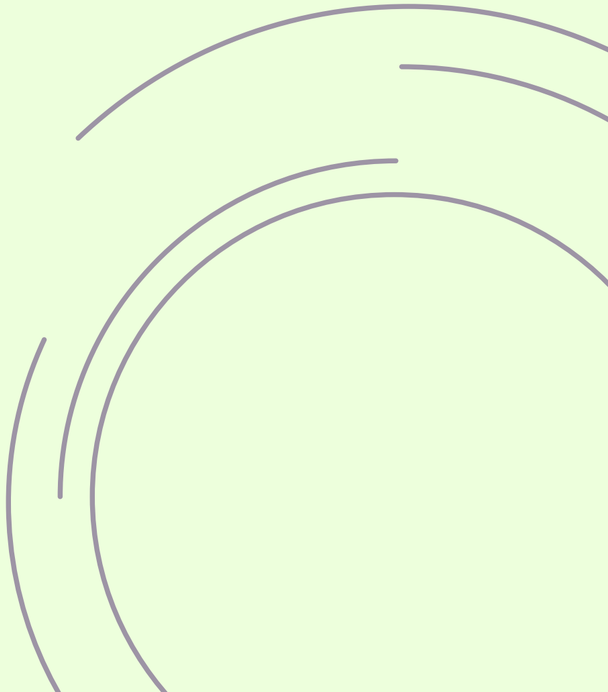
Then he starts running out early.

He starts getting additional opioids and benzodiazepines outside his prescription.

He begins scheming about how to get more and seeing multiple doctors.

Jack

Where did the pattern change?



Jack

What do you notice?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

Jack

What do you notice?

What else would you need to know?

Function - Freedom - Focus - Fallout

What did they have in common?

Tim - Lana - Buck - Leslie - Jack

What did they have in common?

Tim - Lana - Buck - Leslie - Jack

Rationalizing

Preoccupation

Secrecy

What did they have in common?

Tim - Lana - Buck - Leslie - Jack

Rationalizing

Preoccupation

Secrecy

Loss of control

Neglected priorities

Continuing despite consequences

What did they have in common?

Tim - Lana - Buck - Leslie - Jack

Rationalizing

Preoccupation

Secrecy

Loss of control

Neglected priorities

Continuing despite consequences

Recovery Drift
Different behavior. Familiar pattern.

What about me?

Is there anything I use to change how I feel?

What about me?

Is there anything I use to change how I feel?

Function What is it doing for me?

Freedom How much choice do I still have?

Focus How much of my life is organizing around it?

Fallout What is it costing me?

What about me?

Is there anything I use to change how I feel?

Function What is it doing for me?

Freedom How much choice do I still have?

Focus How much of my life is organizing around it?

Fallout What is it costing me?

Notice the pattern. Don’t rush to label it.

Protecting Recovery

Protecting Recovery

Notice it

Catch the pattern.

Protecting Recovery

Notice it
Catch the pattern.

Name the need
What am I actually trying to get?

Protecting Recovery

Notice it
Catch the pattern.

Name the need
What am I actually trying to get?

Talk about it
Don’t let secrecy do the driving.

Protecting Recovery

Notice it
Catch the pattern.

Name the need
What am I actually trying to get?

Talk about it
Don’t let secrecy do the driving.

Add Options
One coping skill does not need seventeen jobs.

Protecting Recovery

Notice it
Catch the pattern.

Name the need
What am I actually trying to get?

Talk about it
Don’t let secrecy do the driving.

Add Options
One coping skill does not need seventeen jobs.

Use Support
Recovery was never meant to be a solo project.

My Recovery Dashboard

My Recovery Dashboard

Watch What pattern do I need to watch?

My Recovery Dashboard

Watch What pattern do I need to watch?

Notice What would tell me early that something is changing?

My Recovery Dashboard

Watch What pattern do I need to watch?

Notice What would tell me early that something is changing?

Need What am I actually needing?

My Recovery Dashboard

Watch What pattern do I need to watch?

Notice What would tell me early that something is changing?

Need What am I actually needing?

Try What else could I try?

My Recovery Dashboard

Watch What pattern do I need to watch?

Notice What would tell me early that something is changing?

Need What am I actually needing?

Try What else could I try?

Talk Who can I tell *before* I start hiding it?

When the substance changes, does the pattern change?

When the substance changes, does the pattern change?

Recovery isn’t only about what I stop.

When the substance changes, does the pattern change?

Recovery isn’t only about what I stop.

It’s also about what I build instead.